Steady Beat Detectives

LEARNING GOAL

Students keep a steady beat alone and with a group, using only their bodies.

MATERIALS & SETUP

None. A board is optional.
Clear a circle on the floor. Seat students facing you.

TIME	YOU DO	STUDENTS DO
0–5	Greet students at the door. Sit in a circle. Say: “Today we are beat detectives.”	Sit in the circle and copy your sitting position.
5–10	Clap a 4-beat pattern. Wait. Clap it again. Keep it slow and even.	Echo the pattern back together.
10–18	Split the class in half. Tap a steady beat on your knee for group A to walk to; group B keeps the beat on their laps. Swap after 4 minutes.	Group A walks the circle stepping on each tap. Group B pats the beat.
18–28	Teach “Engine, Engine, Number Nine.” Speak the words in rhythm first, then pat the beat while saying them.	Say the rhyme, then pat and say together.
28–38	Play “beat freeze”: tap, then stop. Restart. Then let a student lead.	Move to the beat and freeze when the beat stops.
38–43	Sit down. Ask: “Where else do you hear a steady beat?”	Name places: heart, clock, footsteps, rain.
43–45	Line up to your tap.	Line up on the beat, one tap per step.

IF IT GOES WRONG

- Too loud: drop your voice to a whisper and do a “silent beat” on knees only.
- A student refuses: give them the job of “beat inspector” and let them watch for steady beats.
- Short on time: cut the freeze game and go straight to the closing questions.

Differentiation: Advanced: let a student lead the echo pattern. Support: keep the pattern to two beats.